



Reading: Non-Project Manager's Agile Cheat Sheet

Estimated duration: 2 minutes

What is the purpose of a Non-Project Manager's Agile Cheat Sheet?

Agile projects move fast, and while you may not be a Project Manager, your role as a stakeholder, subject matter expert, or customer representative is essential. This cheat sheet highlights your role during each phase of a Sprint, helping ensure that value is delivered.

Phase	Overview (what happens)	Where the non-PM should be involved
Sprint planning	The team, led by the Product Owner, defines what can be delivered in the Sprint and how that work will be achieved. Key activities include refining the Product Backlog, selecting User Stories, establishing the Sprint Goal, and building the Sprint Backlog.	- Share input for User Stories and acceptance criteria - Participate in backlog prioritization - Support in selecting User Stories that align with customer priorities - Help validate the Sprint Goal
Sprint (Execution)	The Development Team delivers the agreed Sprint Backlog. Daily Scrums track progress and highlight impediments. Work should align with the Sprint Goal.	- Remove blockers under your control (e.g., resources and approvals) - Provide timely clarification when asked - Help keep focus by preventing distractions or scope creep
Sprint review	The team demonstrates the working product to stakeholders. Feedback is gathered to adapt the Product Backlog.	- Actively review the product - Provide customer/operations feedback - Highlight gaps, opportunities, or risks
Retrospective	The Scrum Team reflects on the Sprint and identifies improvements for the next one.	- Validate feasibility of proposed improvements - Share organizational constraints - Reinforce team morale by recognizing successes

Summary

Non-PMs play a critical role in Agile. By engaging in Sprint Planning, supporting execution, giving feedback in Reviews, and validating improvements in Retrospectives, you ensure the product not only gets built, but gets built right. Agile thrives on collaboration, and your voice ensures that the team stays focused on delivering value.

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